

these are CodeChef, SPOJ, UVa or Codeforces. These are online compilers that can compile and execute programs. Furthermore, the judge runs the code with strict time and memory constraints and tests it on pre-constructed test cases to evaluate the code. These judges have a number of problems which are sorted according to the level of difficulty or number of successful submissions. Start with easy problems and gradually you can move up. Often you may come across problems where you are required to learn a new algorithm or a technique to solve. These websites also offer discussion forums and editorials, in order to make learning easy and efficient.

In addition to forums, these sites run coding challenges also known as hackathons. These challenges give a fixed amount of time to solve problems where the time duration may vary from a few hours to several days. Often companies hold their own hackathons as a hiring challenge. These challenges help you increase your coding speed as well as build your ability to perform under pressure within a fixed time duration.

Learn from other people who are experienced in the field of programming. They can be your friends, professors or acquaintances. You can also join groups of like-minded coders and hang out with the coding community to learn from the group members and share your knowledge with others.

Diversifying your skills

Once you have a good command over the language you started with you can start branching to other languages and it will be a good idea to learn a new language that supplements the one you currently know. You can also pick a language that specifically interests you, and since you are already good at logic, new syntaxes won't take a lot of time to master. If you had picked a language which was procedural, it would be a good time to migrate to an object oriented language. But you should keep in mind that the number of languages you know is never a parameter of your coding skills because logic is always the emphasis, not the language.

You can also learn support languages such as markup. These languages are not categorized as programming languages, but are often used in conjunction with them. HTML, XML and CSS are popular examples of support languages. If you wish to go for web development, it's essential to learn HTML and CSS along with PHP; while HTML is used to display data, XML is essentially used to describe data and is extensively used in Android. Both of these do not come under programming languages yet are essential for design and development.